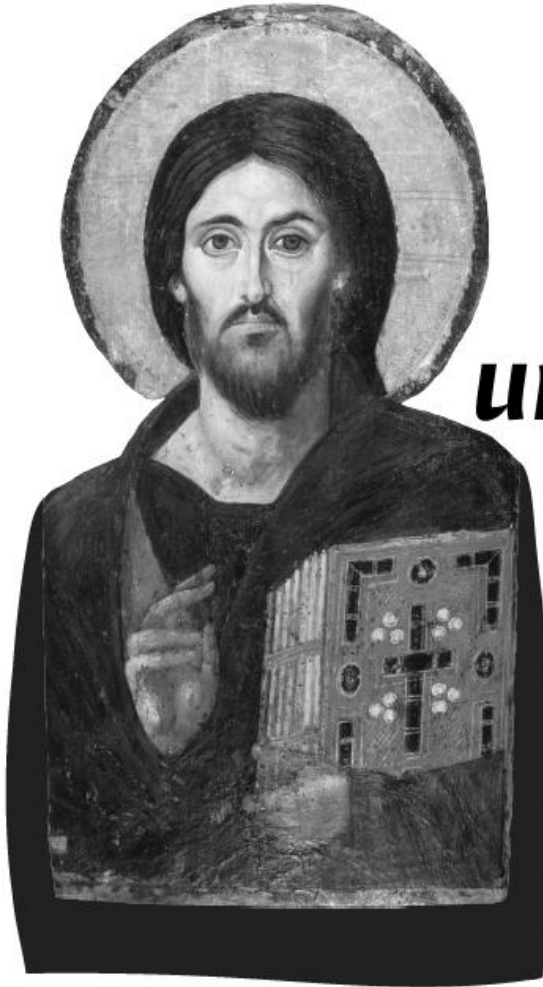




unexpected
TRUTHS

September 13, 2026

ST. PETER LUTHERAN CHURCH | Fort Collins, CO

September 13, 2026

16th Sunday after Pentecost

WELCOME TO WORSHIP!

At St. Peter, our worship is designed to praise God and aid our growth in faith and knowledge of our awesome God. The worship service is printed in its entirety in this bulletin for your convenience. Feel free to ask Pastor Spaude or others in the congregation if you have questions. Or go to our website, stpeterwels.com

Children. *We enjoy the worshiping family, so children are included in our worship services.*

- **Children's message:** Offered during the worship service. Parents, feel free to come to the front with your child if it will help them feel more comfortable.
- **Cry Room:** Located near the entryway. If you do have to leave the sanctuary with your child. Both the cry room and the entry room are wired for sound.
- **Sunday School:** For children ages 3 through high school between services while the adults are in Bible Study. There is childcare for those children under 3.
- **Busy bags:** For your children are available in the entry room for use during worship.

Visitors, please do not feel obligated. The offering plate will be passed; please do not feel obligated to take part in the offering, although you are welcome to do so. Our members do so as an expression to the Lord of our thanks & praise for his amazing love!

We do hope you will sign our guest book page on the credenza in the entry room so that we know you were here in case we did not get to say hello.

Join us. After the morning service, we join for fellowship, coffee, & snacks in the fellowship hall (adjacent to the sanctuary doors). Then, about 9:30 we start the Adult Bible Study.

Restrooms. Located in the Fellowship Hall. If you need directions, please ask an usher.

TODAY'S WORSHIP FOCUS

UNEXPECTED TRUTH: Forgiveness is for Me

Forgiveness does not come naturally to human beings. It is expected that humans will defend themselves, lash out when attacked, hold grudges, and bite back. So, when human beings hear that they are forgiven, they may even be suspicious or skeptical.

Jesus tells a parable that contrasts the forgiveness of God with our own unforgiving sinful nature. God forgives our huge debt. Who can comprehend such unexpected mercy? Certainly not unmerciful servants, who refuse to forgive small debts. Have mercy on us, Lord, and teach us to forgive like you!

SERVICE OF THE WORD

Forgive Our Sins as We Forgive

CW 733

1 "For - give our sins as we for - give,"
2 How can your par - don reach and bless
3 In blaz - ing light your cross re - veals
4 Lord, cleanse the depths with - in our souls

you taught us, Lord, to pray, but you a - lone can
the un - for - giv - ing heart that broods on wrongs and
the truth we dim - ly knew: how small are oth - ers'
and bid re - sent - ment cease; then, bound to all in

grant us grace to live the words we say.
will not let old bit - ter - ness de - part?
debts to us, how great our debt to you!
bonds of love, our lives will spread your peace.

Text: Rosamond E. Herklots, 1905–1987, alt. Tune: A Supplement to Kentucky Harmony, Harrisonburg, 1820, ed. Ananias Davison Press. Used by permission: OneLicense no. 707551 Tune: Public domain

INVOCATION

The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ and the love of God and the fellowship of the Holy Spirit be with you.

And also with you.

CONFESSION

We have come into the presence of God, who created us to love and serve him as his dear children. But we have disobeyed him and deserve only his wrath and punishment. Therefore, let us confess our sins to him and plead for his mercy.

Merciful Father in heaven, I am altogether sinful from birth. In countless ways I have sinned against you and do not deserve to be called your child. But trusting in Jesus, my Savior, I pray: Have mercy on me according to your unfailing love. Cleanse me from my sin, and take away my guilt.

God, our heavenly Father, has forgiven all your sins. By the perfect life and innocent death of our Lord Jesus Christ, he has removed your guilt forever. You are his own dear child. May God give you strength to live according to his will.

Amen.

In the peace of forgiveness, let us praise the Lord.

C: Oh, taste and see that the Lord is good. Bless - ed are
they who take ref - uge in him. Your Word, O Lord, is e -
ter - nal; it stands firm in the heav -
ens. Your faith - ful - ness con - tin - ues for -
ev - er. Oh, taste and see that the Lord is good.
Bless - ed are they who take ref - uge in him.

PRAYER OF THE DAY

Lord God, heavenly Father, you graciously forgive us all our sins and abundantly provide for all our needs of body and soul. Give us confidence in your mercy, and teach us also to be merciful to our neighbor, that we willingly forgive all people, and judging only ourselves, lead blessed lives to your glory; through your Son, Jesus Christ our Lord, who lives and reigns with you and the Holy Spirit, one God, now and forever.

C: A - men.

1st READING

Genesis 50:15–21, EHV

Joseph was quick to forgive his brothers.

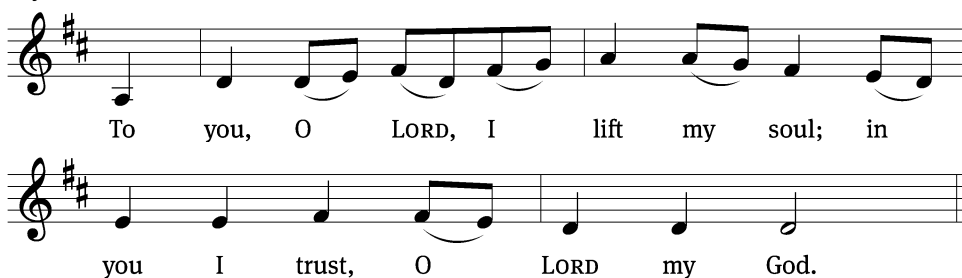
¹⁵When Joseph's brothers saw that their father was dead, they said, "It may be that Joseph will hate us and will pay us back in full for all of the evil that we did to him." ¹⁶They sent the following message to Joseph: "Before he died your father commanded us, ¹⁷'You are to tell Joseph, "Please forgive the offense of your brothers and their sin, because they did evil to you.'" Now, please

forgive the offense of the servants of the God of your father.” Joseph wept when they spoke to him. ¹⁸His brothers also came and fell down in front of him, and they said, “See now, we are your servants.” ¹⁹Joseph said to them, “Do not be afraid, for am I in the place of God? ²⁰You meant evil against me, but God meant it for good, to bring this to pass and to keep many people alive, as it is this day. ²¹Now therefore, do not be afraid. I will nourish you and your little ones.” He comforted them and spoke to them in a kind way.

To You, O LORD, I Lift My Soul

Psalm 25A

Refrain



Tone



Refrain

LORD, forgive my iniquity, though / it is great.
Turn to me and be gracious to me, for I am lonely and af- / flicted.
Look on my affliction and / my distress
and take away / all my sins.

**Glory be to the Father and / to the Son
and to the Holy / Spirit,
as it was in the be- / ginning,
is now, and will be forever. / Amen.**

Refrain

Tune: Mark Haas Setting: Mark Haas Music: © 2014 Mark Haas. Used by permission: OneLicense no. 707551

2nd READING

Ephesians 4:29—5:2, EHV

²⁹Do not let any unwholesome talk come from your mouths. Say only what is beneficial when there is a need to build up others, so that it will be a blessing to those who hear. ³⁰Do not grieve the Holy Spirit of God, with whom you were sealed for the day of redemption. ³¹Get rid of every kind of bitterness, rage, anger, quarreling, and slander, along with every kind of malice. ³²Instead, be kind and compassionate to one another, forgiving one another, just as God in Christ has forgiven us. ¹Therefore, be imitators of God as his dearly loved children. ²And walk in love, just as Christ loved us and gave himself for us, as a fragrant offering and sacrifice to God.

CHILDREN'S SERMON

Jesus Came, the Heavens Adoring

CW 319



1 Je - sus came, the heav'ns a - dor - ing, came with peace from
2 Je - sus comes a - gain in mer - cy when our hearts are
3 Je - sus comes to hearts re - joic - ing, bring - ing news of
4 Je - sus comes on clouds tri - um - phant when the heav'ns shall



realms on high; Je - sus came to win re - demp - tion,
worn with care; Je - sus comes a - gain in an - swer
sins for - giv'n; Je - sus comes with words of glad - ness,
pass a - way. Je - sus comes a - gain in glo - ry;



low - ly came on earth to die; Al - le - lu - ia!
to an ear - nest, heart - felt prayer, Al - le - lu - ia!
lead - ing souls re - deemed to heav'n. Al - le - lu - ia!
let us, then, our hom - age pay, Al - le - lu - ia!



Al - le - lu - ia! came in deep hu - mil - i - ty.
Al - le - lu - ia! comes to save us from de - spair.
Al - le - lu - ia! Hope to all the world is giv'n.
ev - er sing - ing till the dawn of end - less day.

Text: Godfrey Thring, 1823–1903, abr., alt. Tune: Geistreiches Gesang-Buch, Darmstadt, 1698 Text and tune: Public domain

VERSE OF THE DAY

Colossians 3:13

Alleluia. "Bear with one another and forgive each other if anyone has a complaint against anyone else. Forgive, just as Christ forgave you." Alleluia.



C: Al - le - lu - ia! Al - le - lu - ia! Al - le - lu - ia!



These words are writ - ten that we may be-lieve that



Je - sus is the Christ, the Son of God.



Al - le - lu - ia! Al - le - lu - ia! Al - le - lu - ia!

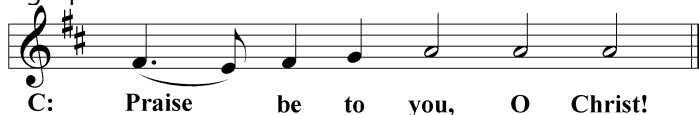
SERMON TEXT (GOSPEL)

Matthew 18:21–35, EHV

¹Then Peter came up and asked Jesus, "Lord, how many times must I forgive my brother when he sins against me? As many as seven times?" ²²Jesus said to him, "Not seven times, but I tell you as many as seventy-seven times. ²³For this reason the kingdom of heaven is like a king who wanted to settle accounts with his servants. ²⁴When he began to settle them, a man who owed him ten thousand talents was brought to him. ²⁵Because the man was not able to pay the debt, his master ordered that he be sold, along with his wife, children, and all that he owned to repay the debt. ²⁶"Then the servant fell down on his knees in front of him, saying, 'Master, be patient with me, and I will pay you everything!' ²⁷The master of that servant had pity on him, released him, and forgave him the debt. ²⁸"But when that servant went out, he found one of his fellow servants who owed him one hundred denarii. He grabbed him and began choking him, saying, 'Pay me what you owe!' ²⁹"So his fellow servant fell down and begged him, saying, 'Be patient with me, and I will pay

you back!' ³⁰But he refused. Instead he went off and threw the man into prison until he could pay back what he owed. ³¹"When his fellow servants saw what had happened, they were very distressed. They went and reported to their master everything that had taken place. ³²"Then his master called him in and said to him, 'You wicked servant! I forgave you all that debt when you begged me to. ³³Should you not have had mercy on your fellow servant just as I had mercy on you?' ³⁴His master was angry and handed him over to the jailers until he could pay back everything he owed. ³⁵"This is what my heavenly Father will also do to you unless each one of you forgives his brother from his heart."

This is the gospel of our Lord.



DON'T KEEP SCORE!

1. God doesn't.
2. So we don't either.

Jesus Paid It All

CW 562

1 I hear the Sav - ior say, "Thy strength in - deed is small!
 2 Lord, now in - deed I find thy pow'r, and thine a - lone
 3 For noth - ing good have I where - by thy grace to claim;
 4 And when, be - fore the throne, I stand in him com - plete,
 Child of weak - ness, watch and pray, find in me thine all in all."
 can_ change the lep - er's spots and_ melt the heart of stone.
 I'll_ wash my gar - ments white in the blood of Cal - v'ry's Lamb.
 "Je - sus died my soul to save," my_ lips shall still re - peat.

Refrain
 Je - sus paid it all, all to him I owe;



sin had left a crim-son stain, he washed it white as snow.

Text: Elvina M. Hall, 1820–1889 Tune: John T. Grape, 1835–1915 Text and tune: Public domain

THE APOSTLES' CREED

**I believe in God, the Father Almighty,
maker of heaven and earth.**

**I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord,
who was conceived by the Holy Spirit,
born of the Virgin Mary,
suffered under Pontius Pilate,
was crucified, died, and was buried.**

He descended into hell.

The third day he rose again from the dead.

He ascended into heaven

and is seated at the right hand of God the Father Almighty.

From there he will come to judge the living and the dead.

**I believe in the Holy Spirit,
the holy Christian Church,
the communion of saints,
the forgiveness of sins,
the resurrection of the body,
and the life everlasting. Amen.**

OFFERING

Online giving options: 1) <http://stpeterwels.com>; or 2) the QR code at the end of the bulletin.

Offering Hymn

We Give Thee but Thine Own

CW 750



1 We give thee but thine own, what-e'er the gift may be;
2 May we thy boun-ties thus as stew-ards true re-ceive



all that we have is thine a-lone, a trust, O Lord, from thee.
and glad-ly, as thou bless-est us, to thee our first-fruits give.

Text: William W. How, 1823–1897, abr. Tune: William H. Monk, 1823–1889 Text and tune: Public domain

PRAYER OF THE CHURCH

Let us pray: Gracious King, we stand in need of Your mercy. Spare us those punishments which we, by our sins, have deserved. Soften our hearts toward one another, that we would share with others the forgiveness You deliver to us today. Lord, in Your mercy,

hear our prayer.

Heavenly Father, bless our Synod and those who lead it, that we may be united in witnessing to Your love in Christ Jesus. Lord, in Your mercy,

hear our prayer.

Heavenly Father, build our homes upon that same mercy you have shown us. May brother and sister, husband and wife, parent and child live together in peace and give witness to the glory of God's gracious ways. Lord, in Your mercy,

hear our prayer.

Almighty Lord, You brought Joseph to rule and shepherd Egypt. Raise up new Josephs among us to rule with wisdom and fairness according to your will. Lord, in Your mercy,

hear our prayer.

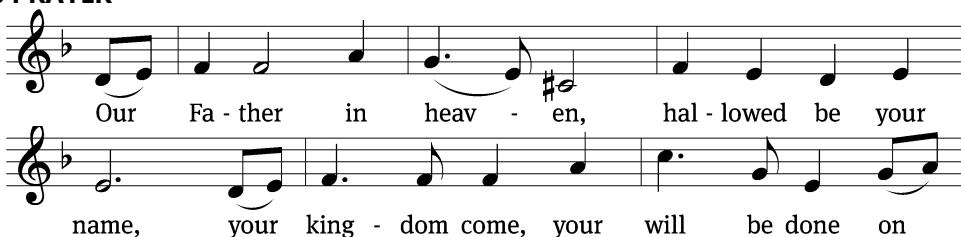
Lord, You hold in Your hands all who suffer. Comfort them and let us confess that, whether we live or die, we belong to You. Lord, in Your mercy,

hear our prayer.

Holy Lord, lead us to pursue reconciliation, that we may stand before You forgiven and united in faith. Give us unity of doctrine, and help us to walk together in harmony of life.

We pray all these prayers in the name of the one who taught us to pray:

LORD'S PRAYER



earth as in heav - en. Give us to - day our
dai - ly bread. For - give us our sins, as
we for - give those who sin a - gainst us.
Lead us not in - to temp - ta - tion, but de -
liv - er us from e - vil. For the king - dom, the
pow - er, and the glo - ry are yours
now and for - ev - er. A - men.

PRAYER FOR GRACE

Almighty God, we thank you for teaching us the things you want us to believe and do. Help us by your Holy Spirit to keep your Word in pure hearts that we may be strengthened in faith, guided in holiness, and comforted in life and in death, through Jesus Christ, our Lord, who lives and reigns with you and the Holy Spirit, one God, now and forever.

C: A - men.

BLESSING

Brothers and sisters, go in peace. Live in harmony with one another. Serve the Lord with gladness.
The Lord bless and keep you.
The Lord make his face shine on you and be gracious to you.
The Lord look on you with favor and ✠ give you peace.



Praise, My Soul, the King of Heaven

CW 621



- 1 Praise, my soul, the King of heav - en; to his feet your
- 2 Praise him for his grace and fa - vor to his peo - ple
- 3 Fa - ther - like he tends and spares us; well our fee - ble
- 4 An - gels, help us to a - dore him; you be - hold him



trib - ute bring. Ran - somed, healed, re - stored, for - giv - en,
in dis - tress. Praise him, still the same as ev - er,
frame he knows. In his hand he gent - ly bears us,
face to face. Sun and moon, bow down be - fore him;



ev - er - more his prais - es sing; Al - le - lu - ia,
slow to chide, and swift to bless, Al - le - lu - ia,
res - cues us from all our foes; Al - le - lu - ia,
all who dwell in time and space, Al - le - lu - ia,



al - le - lu - ia! praise the ev - er - last - ing King!
al - le - lu - ia! glo - rious in his faith - ful - ness!
al - le - lu - ia! wide - ly yet his mer - cy flows!
al - le - lu - ia! praise with us the God of grace!

Text: Henry F. Lyte, 1793–1847 Tune: John Goss, 1800–1880 Text and tune: Public domain

Acknowledgments

Unless otherwise noted, Scripture quotations are from the Holy Bible, Evangelical Heritage Version® (EHV®) © 2017 Wartburg Project. All rights reserved. Used by permission. Liturgical and musical settings of Scripture based on text from The Holy Bible, New International Version®, NIV®, Copyright © 1973, 1978, 1984, 2011 by Biblica, Inc.™ Used by permission of Zondervan. All rights reserved worldwide. Software distributed in partnership with Northwestern Publishing House. Created by Christian Worship: Service Builder © 2026 Concordia Publishing House.

IN THE WORD TODAY

Bible Study | Come Follow Me
Sunday School | God Helps Joseph Forgive

SUNDAY SCHOOL MEMORY TREASURE

[Forgive] one another, as God in Christ forgave you.
Ephesians 4:32

CELEBRATIONS

Birthdays: Valerie Hanson 9/15 Bill Herzog 9/16 Lon Knudson 9/18
Mary Clifton 9/18
Anniversaries: Trevor & Ashley Daniels 9/15/2012

NEWS & ANNOUNCEMENTS

NEW DIRECTORY FOR REVIEW

Review this week and next

There are 3 draft copies of a new directory that we would like your review for accuracy. Please put a "OK" next to your household name if it is accurate or an "X" with corrections after reviewing. If you prefer, email church@stpeterwels.com with corrections. That also works.

STITCHES OF FAITH

Mon, Sept 14, 1:00-4:00 Different Location

Please note that for 9/14 Stitches of Faith is at Rhonda Pille's home, 1807 Overlook Dr 80526.

DANIEL AND THE FIERY FURNACE

Saturday, Sept 19, early afternoon

The Fellowship Ministry would like to invite you and any guests to watch Daniel and the Fiery Furnace together on Saturday, September 19th, in the early afternoon (location, time, and ticket price will be confirmed once the schedule is released). After the movie, all are invited back to St. Peter for snacks and a discussion about the movie. Fellowship Ministry will cover the ticket costs. Look for a Google Form to come out in the future where you can sign up for a ticket. Pastor and Karen Thomas are available if you have any questions, either in person, by phone, or by email.

YOUTH MOVIE & LUNCH

September 20, 12:30 – 3:30 pm

St. Peter youth are invited to join together for an afternoon showing of the movie, Luther, in the fellowship hall. A discussion of the movie will be held afterward. Lunch and popcorn will be provided. Bring a favorite movie snack to share if desired, but this is optional! Kaylene Fisbeck is hosting this event. Thank you Kaylene!



WELS CHRISTIAN GIVING PRESENTATION

September 27, between services

More and more of the members of our sister churches in the WELS are arranging gifts for ministry in their wills. On September 27, we plan to have our Christian Giving Counselor, Pastor Nathan Cordes, with us. He will help us walk through the idea of planning our own gift for spreading the good news about Jesus to others after the Lord takes us to His heavenly home.

SERVING NEXT WEEK (9/20/26) (SEE FULL SCHEDULE ON [STPETERWELS.COM/SCHEDULE](http://stpeterwels.com/schedule))

	<u>1st Service</u>	<u>2nd Service</u>
Preacher	Joel Spaude	Joel Spaude
Accompanist	Ben Collura	Ben Collura
Ushers	Brian Pinon & James Free	Mason Smith & Jeff Perry
Acolytes	Elsie Cobb/Colton Grim	Beckett Andersland
TLC Room	between services ->	Alex & Allison
Altar Care	Ashley set up	Deb clean up
Projection	Brian Balfour	Oscar / Blake
OTHER SERVING	(9/26) Mason	
	(10/3) Brenda	

Online Giving

1) via our website: <http://stpeterwels.com>; or 2) scan the QR code. Thank you.



PASTOR JOEL SPAUDE

(970) 556-4969 (cell)

joel.spaude@stpeterwels.com

CHURCH OFFICE – ANGIE GENDILL

(970) 226-3481

church@stpeterwels.com

PRESCHOOL DIRECTOR KAYLENE FISBECK

(970) 632-2097 (Preschool)

preschool@stpeterwels.com or
littlelambs@stpeterwels.com

VICAR AIDAN LEWIS

(251) 753-5068

vicar@stpeterwels.com



4610 Hogan Drive, Fort Collins



church@stpeterwels.com



facebook.com/stpeterwels
[Facebook.com/stpeterlittlelambs](https://facebook.com/stpeterlittlelambs)



stpeterwels.com/sermons



MY WORSHIP NOTES



For children to use during worship.

Name: _____ Date: _____

What is the name of the church season or special day today? _____

What is the color of the church today? Circle one:

Blue White Purple Red Green

The sermon text was: _____ This is in the: ☐ Old Testament ☐ New Testament What was the sermon about? _____ _____ _____ _____ _____		
My favorite hymn today was: _____		
Did we have a Sacrament today?  Baptism? ☐ Yes ☐ No  Communion? ☐ Yes ☐ No	Draw a picture of something you heard or saw today: _____ _____ _____ _____	
What did you learn about God today? _____ _____ _____ _____		